



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Spirit Academy
School Website: <https://holyspiritacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Holy Spirit Academy (Monticello, MN, 55362) (HSA) demonstrates a robust CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories of the classical education rubric. The public materials clearly foreground Catholic theology and liturgical life integrated with an academically rigorous, formation-forward program. The curriculum emphasizes liberal arts foundations, a cross-disciplinary approach, and Great Books/Natural Law-inflected inquiry, while pedagogy centers on Socratic discussion, memory work, and contemplation. Faculty are described as virtuous exemplars who embody the living curriculum, and parents are positioned as co-educators with ongoing opportunities for engagement through formal structures like a Parent Guild and regular visits. Collectively, these elements support a classical framework that prioritizes truth, goodness, and beauty as knowable realities and aims at formation of character in a Catholic context.

Key strengths across categories include:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations integrated throughout coursework, liturgical life, and school culture (Mass, adoration, Divine Office, Catholic worldview).
- A formation-centered purpose emphasizing virtue, wisdom, and perennial truths rather than mere job-readiness.
- A curriculum aligned with classical liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium elements), with Humane Letters and Latin, and explicit emphasis on Great Books/historical engagement.
- Pedagogical practices that incorporate Socratic seminars for humanities/theology, with contemplative and memory-focused approaches in lower grades and rhetoric/seminars in upper grades.
- A faculty culture described as virtuous, mentorship-driven, and living the curriculum, including an oath of fidelity to Magisterium and commitment to faith formation.
- A strong, active parent/community partnership with open campus visits, a Parent Guild, and family involvement in school life.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot**Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school foregrounds a Catholic, Christ-centered education integrated into every discipline, with theology in a place of primacy and explicit reference to Catholic intellectual tradition. Mission statements emphasize being “Grounded in the Truth of Christ” and educating within a Catholic tradition. - Liturgical and communal life is described as integral: regular Mass, daily adoration, daily classroom prayer, and liturgical rhythms are noted as core to formation. - The pedagogy and culture emphasize sacramental imagination, sacred music, and a Catholic worldview permeating the program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present in public materials: theology, liturgy, Mass, worship, sacred music, chant, sacraments, Divine Office, sacramental worldview, imago Dei, Logos, virtue, wonder, reverence, Catholic, sacred tradition, sacred text, sacred music, moral formation, etc. - Negative keywords: essentially none observed in public materials.

Why this rating - The materials consistently align with transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and a Catholic theological grounding, with liturgical life and a sacramental worldview evident throughout. This is a strong match to the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 1 and minimal-to-no presence of Negative indicators. The alignment is reinforced by explicit Catholic liturgical practices and theology integrated across the curriculum.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school states its aim as formation in virtue and wisdom, grounded in the truth of Christ, and formation of character and vocation through an integrated, holistic education. Mission and philosophy emphasize formation and lifelong purposes rather than mere job-readiness. - The emphasis on perennial truths, “integration,” and a cross-disciplinary approach supports the classical telos of education toward wisdom and the true, good, and beautiful. - The presence of a capstone experience and a culture oriented toward the formation of authentic, virtuous citizens aligns with the classical emphasis on moral imagination and human excellence.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, contemplation, great conversation, classical heritage, moral imagination, human flourishing, lifelong learning. - Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials.

Why this rating - The public materials emphasize formation, virtue, and wisdom in a teleological sense (telos) and stress the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, consistent with classical aims. There is no overt emphasis on career readiness in lieu of formation, which supports CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as integrated, with emphasis on liberal arts and the Great Books tradition within a Catholic framework. The school highlights Humane Letters (Writing & Speaking), Latin, and a sequence of theology, humanities, science, mathematics, and languages. The program is framed as liberal-arts-based, with explicit cross-disciplinary integration and a respect for the order of learning (theology in pride of place). - The Seven Liberal Arts are referenced in the school's literature about classical education (Trivium and Quadrivium), and there is explicit emphasis on Great Books/primary texts and the Great Conversation in the classical education lexicon reflected in the knowledge-base materials. The site describes an integrated curriculum and humane letters; Latin language study; and a history across years that integrates humanities, theology, and sciences. - Choir and the arts are included (sacred music, Gregorian chant, etc.) as part of a holistic curriculum, aligning with the liberal arts tradition.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, music), Great Books, primary sources, classics, Western civilization, Latin, history, memory work, recitation, narration, chant, sacred music, humane letters, writing & speaking, interdisciplinary/harmonia of subjects, integration, wonder, sacred tradition, sacred texts, moral philosophy, theological aesthetics. - Negative keywords present: minimal to none; the public materials do not foreground social studies substitution for history or project-based learning as primary modalities; some elements of modernity (tech used sparingly) are noted, but not as a curriculum critique.

Why this rating - The public descriptions clearly align with classical curriculum tenets: liberal arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books/historic-text engagement, integration across disciplines, and an explicit aim to cultivate wonder and moral formation. The presence of humane letters, Latin, and a cross-disciplinary structure supports CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT or NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy features contemplative and restful elements (scholé-like restraint) alongside rigorous engagement in upper grades via Socratic seminar/discussion and rhetoric/eloquence training. The public materials explicitly mention Socratic method in humanities/theology, small class sizes, and opportunities for students to present and argue (speeches, capstone work). Lower- and upper-school approaches include singing, memory work, and disciplined study to deepen memory and delight. - The curriculum emphasizes cross-disciplinary integration and the cross-subject discussion that fosters a classical “great conversation” approach, with a strong emphasis on memory work and recitation in pedagogy. The presence of daily examen, choral singing, and a capstone project are consistent with memory, rhetoric, and moral formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic method, seminar, dialogue, recitation, narration, chanting, memory work, liturgical integration, rhetoric, debate, capstone, oratory, training in rhetoric, formation through pedagogy, scholé, contemplation, wonder. - Negative keywords present: experiential learning focus, project-based learning dominance, student-directed construction, and constructivist signals are not strongly evidenced as the primary approach; the site emphasizes traditional Socratic/seminar methods alongside rest and contemplation.

Why this rating - Pedagogy aligns with classical practice: Socratic inquiry in upper levels, memory/narration-rich lower levels, and rhetorical training in advanced work, balanced with contemplative/restful elements. The material supports CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT or NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty is described as virtuous mentors who model virtue and knowledge, forming a living curriculum. The materials emphasize an oath of fidelity to the Magisterium, and the faculty are portrayed as agents who extend beyond the classroom to form faith and virtue. There is an emphasis on small class sizes and faculty leadership in forming student character, indicating a teacher-centered, character-formation approach typical of classical schools. - The notion of the faculty as the “living curriculum” and a “portrait of a teacher” aligns with classical expectations of teacher as exemplar and guide. The materials emphasize faculty as lifelong learners and participants in great-books seminars for faculty development.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, Masters/Tutors/Mentors, mentorship, virtue exemplars, moral formation, teacher training in classical pedagogy, fidelity to Magisterium. - Negative keywords present: signals like “facilitators” or “guides on the side” or “certification-driven” are not prominent in the public materials; no explicit negative indicators observed.

Why this rating - The public materials portray faculty as central to the formation project, with explicit commitments to fidelity, mentorship, and the living curriculum. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty as moral exemplars and integral to the curriculum, not just service providers.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families as co-educators, parent formation, and community involvement. There is explicit promotion of parent participation in lectures, events, and book studies, along with an open-campus philosophy and frequent opportunities for visits. The existence of a Parent Guild and emphasis on family engagement are explicit signals of a classical parental-community orientation. - The culture highlights the home-school connection and classical formation extended to families (family catechesis, living tradition in the family, etc.). This aligns with classical expectations for a strong partnership with parents.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, parent partnerships, open campus, family involvement, home-school connection, parental engagement, parent education/gatherings, parent guild, study groups. - Negative keywords present: the materials do not emphasize a consumer-model relationship; no significant negative indicators observed.

Why this rating - The evidence shows robust parent involvement structures and a clear philosophy of parents as co-educators, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for parent-community partnerships.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable for a purely CLASSICAL overall classification. The school exhibits a coherent classical orientation across all six categories with strong evidence from public materials (Catholic worldview, integrated curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, Great Books/historical engagement, and parent partnership). No substantial needle-moving changes are required to reach a fully CLASSICAL designation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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